SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #6 · CHRIST

"I need a priest, a saint, or Mary to bring my prayers to God."

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Where it often comes from

Being taught as a child that ordinary people should not speak to God directly. A church culture where only clergy prayed aloud or led worship. Feeling too sinful or unimportant to approach God yourself. Seeing God as a distant king who only receives messages through officials. Some traditions ask saints to pray for them, much as we ask a friend to pray, but that is different from believing you *cannot* go to God yourself.

What Scripture teaches

Through Jesus, every believer has direct access to the Father. Jesus is the one mediator between God and people, and He Himself intercedes for you. You are invited to come boldly to God's throne of grace, in your own words, at any time. Asking others to pray for you is a gift, but it never replaces your own open door to God.

> *"For there is one God, and there is one mediator between God and men, the man Christ Jesus, who gave Himself as a ransom for all—the testimony that was given at just the right time"* **(1 Timothy 2:5–6)**.

Also see

> "Let us then approach the throne of grace with confidence, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help us in our time of need" **(Hebrews 4:16)**.

> "In Him and through faith in Him we may enter God's presence with boldness and confidence" **(Ephesians 3:12)**.

> "Who is there to condemn us? For Christ Jesus, who died, and more than that was raised to life, is at the right hand of God—and He is interceding for us" **(Romans 8:34)**.

> "But when you pray, go into your inner room, shut your door, and pray to your Father, who is unseen. And your Father, who sees what is done in secret, will reward you" **(Matthew 6:6)**.

Common self-statements

- God won't listen if I pray on my own.
- My prayers aren't good enough to reach God.
- Someone holier than me has to ask for me.
- I don't know the right words, so I shouldn't pray.
- God is too important to hear from someone like me.
- I have to go through the proper channels.

Common logical errors

- **Overgeneralization:** Turning "others can pray for me" into "only others can reach God for me."
- **Discounting the positive:** Overlooking the many invitations in Scripture to come to God directly.

- **Labeling:** Calling yourself “too unworthy” to pray, when Christ has already made you welcome.
- **Projection:** Picturing God as a busy official who only takes messages through a secretary.
- **Emotional reasoning:** Concluding “I feel unworthy, so God must not want to hear from me.”

Challenging questions

- Where in Scripture does God say I may not speak to Him myself?
- If Jesus is the one mediator, who else do I really need?
- Why would God invite me to come boldly if He did not want to hear me?
- Is it possible I learned this from a person or system, not from God?
- Does a loving father want his children to speak to him only through others?
- Can I ask others to pray for me and still pray myself?
- What happened the last time I prayed honestly in my own words?

Truth summary

> I can speak to God myself. Jesus is my mediator, and He opened the way for me to come to the Father with confidence. My simple, honest words are welcome. Others may pray for me, and I am grateful when they do, but I never need permission or a go-between to talk to my Father.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Prayer, How to
- Christ, Mission of
- Christ, Sacrifice of
- Grace
- Prayer, Answers to

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Prayer
- Christ, Who He Is

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> **Overcoming Anxiety** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I need a priest, a saint, or Mary to bring my prayers to God"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I need a priest, a saint, or Mary to bring my prayers to God." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where does Scripture say I can't speak to God myself?
- ☐ If Jesus is my mediator, who else do I need?
- ☐ Why would God invite me to come boldly if He didn't want to hear me?
- ☐ Did I learn this from God or from people?
- ☐ Would a loving father only hear his child through others?
- ☐ What happened when I prayed in my own words?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Jesus is my mediator, and through Him I can speak to God myself.
- ☐ I may come to God with boldness and confidence.
- ☐ My simple, honest words are welcome to my Father.
- ☐ Others can pray for me, and I can pray too.
- ☐ God sees me in secret and hears me.
- ☐ I am invited, not just allowed, to come to God.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **1 Timothy 2:5–6**
  "For there is one God, and there is one mediator between God and men, the man Christ Jesus, who gave Himself as a ransom for all—the testimony that was given at just the right time."
- [ ] **Hebrews 4:16**
  "Let us then approach the throne of grace with confidence, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help us in our time of need."
- [ ] **Ephesians 3:12**
  "In Him and through faith in Him we may enter God's presence with boldness and confidence."
- [ ] **Romans 8:34**
  "Who is there to condemn us? For Christ Jesus, who died, and more than that was raised to life, is at the right hand of God—and He is interceding for us."
- [ ] **Matthew 6:6**
  "But when you pray, go into your inner room, shut your door, and pray to your Father, who is unseen. And your Father, who sees what is done in secret, will reward you."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Prayer log:** Each day, write one thing I told God in my own words, and anything I noticed afterward.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Ephesians 3:12 becomes: "In Him and through faith in Him **Sarah** may enter God's presence with boldness and confidence."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Prayer, How to" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Pray for two minutes in your own words,** out loud or silently, then go on with your day without waiting for a special feeling.
- ☐ **Write a short letter to God** about one real concern, and read it to Him.
- ☐ **Pray a one-sentence prayer** at a time you normally wouldn't, such as in the car or while cooking.
- ☐ **Ask a trusted Christian friend:** "How did you learn to talk to God in your own words?" Write down what they say.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I need a priest, a saint, or Mary to bring my prayers to God": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Something I told God myself
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I need a priest, a saint, or Mary to bring my prayers to God.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You that through Jesus I can come to You myself. Help me reject the lie that I need someone else to reach You. Teach me to speak to You simply and honestly, and to trust that You hear me. Thank You for the people who pray for me, and for the open door You have given me. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.